

ECON311: Critical Review

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Due date in class on March 31st, 2026

General Task

For this writing assignment you are asked to critically analyze the article titled “The COVID crisis and productivity growth”. There are two crucial components to writing a critical review. First, you must provide a clear summary of what you consider the main points of the article. Second, you must provide a critical analysis of these points. Your critical analysis should use concepts that you have learned in this class, other economics classes, and your own additional research on the topic. The final version of your review should be between **five** and **six** double-spaced pages in length.

Critical Reviews are more than merely paraphrasing the author’s main points. It involves a careful examination of an article within the broader context provided by your knowledge of the topic being analyzed. Therefore, it is very important that you consult additional references discussing the main ideas of the article. You will be graded on your general understanding of the article, the thoroughness of your analysis, and the clarity of your argument.

A useful, but not necessary, structure for your analysis will start with an introduction that provides some context and discusses what you consider the key points of the article. In the middle part of the critical review, you should analyze the arguments of the article using the knowledge that you have acquired in your own research. Finally, the conclusion should briefly summarize your critical review and include a concluding sentence on the quality of the article. Any reference you cite should be identified at the end of the paper. As a side note, though the review is called the Critical Review, your discussion should highlight both the strengths and weaknesses of the article.

Format of the Assignment

- Your assignment should be typed, double spaced and have a font size of 12 points.
- The assignment should be either a Word or pdf document.
- You must thoroughly cite your sources using the “APA System”. You can find detailed information about employing the “APA System” to cite your references at <https://www.unbc.ca/academic-success-centre/online-writing-resources>

- Please do not either intentionally or inadvertently plagiarize. The Academic Success Centre at UNBC is a great resource to learn more about plagiarism and writing in general. You can find many handouts with information in the link provided above.
- The use of Generative AI is strictly prohibited (except as a search engine).

Grading Rubric

The Critical Review will be graded out of 50 points as follows

- **Introduction [out of 5 points]**
 - **Excellent [4-5]**
 - * Provides a clear context to the article
 - * Presents a clear and accurate representation of the author's main arguments
 - * Sets up the main thesis of the review article
 - **Good [3-4]**
 - * Provides some context to the article
 - * Presents an accurate representation of the author's main arguments
 - * The main thesis of the review article is not entirely clear
 - **Competent [2-3]**
 - * Provides no context to the article
 - * Presents an inadequate representation of the author's main arguments
 - * There is no main thesis of the review article
 - **Problematic [0-2]**
 - * Provides no context to the article
 - * The author's main arguments are inaccurately represented
 - * There is no main thesis of the review article
- **Main Analysis [out of 30 points]**
 - **Excellent [25-30]**
 - * Provides a clear and detailed critical analysis of the author's main arguments using additional material
 - * Shows independent critical thinking rather than paraphrasing additional material
 - * Criticism concentrates on important economic points and not minor aspects
 - * Shows depth of knowledge of the subject acquired through additional research
 - **Good [20-25]**
 - * Provides a clear critical analysis of the author's main arguments using additional material

- * Shows some independent critical thinking rather than paraphrasing additional material
 - * Criticism concentrates on somewhat economic points and not minor aspects
 - * Shows some knowledge of the subject acquired through additional research
- **Competent [15-20]**
 - * Provides an unclear critical analysis of the author's main arguments using additional material
 - * Mostly paraphrases additional material
 - * Criticism concentrates on minor aspects
 - * Shows very little knowledge of the subject acquired through additional research
- **Problematic [0-15]**
 - * Provides no critical analysis of the author's main arguments using additional material
 - * Mostly paraphrases additional material
 - * Shows no additional independent research
- **Conclusion [out of 5 points]**
 - **Excellent [4-5]**
 - * Summarizes the analysis briefly and accurately
 - **Good [3-4]**
 - * Attempts to summarize the analysis briefly and accurately
 - **Competent [2-3]**
 - * Summarizes the analysis somewhat accurately
 - **Problematic [0-2]**
 - * The conclusion does not summarize the analysis.
- **Exposition [out of 10 points]**
 - **Excellent [8-10]**
 - * Excellent organization of the discussion
 - * Well-written paragraphs with smooth transitions between sentences and across paragraphs
 - * No unnecessary repetition of arguments
 - * Clear explanations
 - * Sources are referenced and cited properly
 - **Good [7-8]**
 - * Good organization of the discussion
 - * Well-written paragraphs with smooth transitions between sentences and across paragraphs

- * Some unnecessary repetition of arguments
- * Explanation not always clear
- * Sources are referenced and cited properly

– **Competent [5-7]**

- * Poor organization of the discussion
- * Paragraphs are not always clear
- * Some unnecessary repetition of arguments
- * Disorganize explanation
- * Sources are sometimes referenced and cited properly

– **Problematic [0-5]**

- * Poor organization of the discussion
- * Paragraphs are not clear
- * Paraphrases without providing context
- * Disorganize explanation
- * Sources are incorrectly referenced and cited